

List of the top app developer platforms

There are two types of app development platforms:

- Platforms that can produce mobile versions of websites or PWAs (progressive Web apps).
- Platforms that can produce native mobile apps – real apps in the full sense, made for specific devices like Android or iPhone.

The following is a list of app development software platforms that you can use. These platforms allow you to design features and elements, as well as design and compile them together for a ready-to-implement mobile app.

- Appy Pie: <https://www.appypie.com>
- Appery: <https://www.appery.io>
- Bizness Apps: <https://www.biznessapps.com>
- Verivo: <http://www.verivo.com>
- Felgo: <https://www.felgo.com>
- GoodBarber: <https://www.goodbarber.com>

Other platforms are Appsmarketstore, Mobincube, Shoutem, MobileRoadie, Snapii, AppSheet, Swiftic, GameSalad, AppsBuilder, etc. You may search for more on Google.

Top mobile app development tools in 2020

The following is the list of the best mobile app development tools.

1. Experitest: This is a leading mobile app testing platform (<http://www.experitest.com>).
2. Headspin: Provides real-world, actionable user experience insights for businesses to improve mobile performance (<http://headspin.io>).
3. AppWatch: A cloud based mobile analytics and security product (<https://www.appwatch.io>).
4. Xamarin: A mobile app development tool for native applications, used to build apps for the iPhone, iPad, Windows and Android (<http://www.xamarin.com>).
5. Appcelerator: Allows developers to create apps with just a few lines of code (<http://www.appcelerator.com>).

Other tools include PhoneGap, Ionic, Mobincube, Longrange, QT, Alpha Anywhere, Sencha, KendoUI, Mobile Angular UI, NativeScript, Onsen UI, FireBase, Swiftic, etc.

Top skills required for mobile app development

Mobile application development involves a set of procedures comprising programming and building software designed for fast-operating handheld devices such as smartphones and tablets. In many ways, it is similar to Web application development, with the difference being that mobile applications are often developed to be specifically tailored to the special functions of the device being used. For example, in the case of a game application developed for an Android platform phone, it may be advantageous to use the phone's accelerometer to offer a unique user experience.

The skills a professional mobile app developer must

have are listed below.

- **Agile methodologies and Scrum development:** Agile methodologies comprise a series of rapid design, build and release events. Scrum management is the best way to manage the projects, and is perfect for highly cross-functional mobile development teams. Scrum enables greater cohesion between developers and clients.
- **UX/UI:** It is essential for developers to understand how the UI directly impacts UX as this decides the success of an app. Developers need to focus on cross-development technologies that offer agile designing tools, as they provide essential options such as a multi-layout manager and drag-and-drop functionalities.
- **Programming languages:** The main work for any mobile app developer is programming. So, they should be proficient in languages such as Java, HTML5, C++, Objective-C, Swift, C# and other frameworks like Flutter, React, Vue, etc, depending on the project.
- **Cloud computing:** This is an important part of mobile app development, and developers should be skilled in technologies like Azure and Amazon Web Services for deploying and managing applications and services.
- **Cyber security:** Making apps secure is one of the key challenges of any enterprise today. Also, end users demand privacy and end-to-end security — from mobile devices to data centres or cloud hosted services. Developers should know about the various types of security threats, and should be proficient in handling mobile security testing or pen testing.
- **Cross-platform capabilities:** It goes without saying that once the app becomes popular, it has to be available on every mobile app platform, whether Android or iOS, or any other app store. Coding native apps makes it difficult to transfer to other platforms and problems crop up. That's why, mobile app developers should have a good knowledge of cross-platform tools like Xamarin, which is based on C# code and provides a strong platform to translate apps into Android, iOS and Windows.
- **Quality assurance and performance testing:** A developer should have strong QA and performance testing skills to make the app perform well and gain the best user feedback, which will lead to a high number of downloads.

Other technologies to know are edge computing, IoT, databases and middleware, all of which are considered as an added advantage for developers to get a headstart in their careers.

In addition to the above technical skills, the following are crucial:

- Creative skills
- Business analytical and data management skills